

Rental Application Fast-Track Checklist — Western Australia

Win the lease, even with no rental history or connections.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice. WA's tenancy laws are under active reform — this checklist reflects the current framework, with a major eviction-rules change proposed but not yet law.

Section 1 — Know Your Rights Before You Apply

- ☐ [] **Know your tenancy is governed by the Residential Tenancies Act 1987 (WA)** — currently under a significant government review, with reforms progressively rolling out.
- ☐ [] **Understand a major reform is proposed but not yet in effect.** In May 2026, the WA Government announced its intention to ban no-grounds terminations, bringing WA into line with most other states — but as at July 2026, this had **not yet been legislated**. Check the current status with Consumer Protection WA before relying on this having already changed.

Section 2 — Documents to Have Ready

- ☐ [] **Photo ID** (driver's licence or passport).
- ☐ [] **Proof of income** — payslips, employment letter, or for students/first-time renters: Centrelink statements, scholarship confirmation, or guarantor documents.
- ☐ [] **Rental history/references** — previous landlord/agent details, or alternative references if you're a first-time renter.
- ☐ [] **Bank statements**, if requested.

Section 3 — The Application Itself

- ☐ [] **Apply promptly after inspecting** — competitive Perth properties can attract high application volumes quickly, particularly given ongoing rental market pressure.
- ☐ [] **Attend the inspection in person if possible.**
- ☐ [] **Follow up politely, once**, if you haven't heard back within a few days.
- ☐ [] **Ask about pet bond requirements upfront** — WA allows a pet bond (recently increased to a maximum of \$350, applicable from the next rent increase) in addition to the standard bond, so factor this into your budgeting if you have a pet.

Section 4 — For Students & First-Time Renters Specifically

- ☐ [] **Consider a guarantor** if you lack independent rental/income history — confirm the specific agency genuinely accepts this.
- ☐ [] **Highlight stability signals** — enrolment confirmation, course length, stable casual work history.
- ☐ [] **Consider co-applying with reliable housemates** for a stronger combined application.
- ☐ [] **Don't be discouraged by rejections** in a competitive market — apply for multiple properties in parallel.

Section 5 — Know Your Position If Things Go Wrong Later

- ☐ [] **Know that fair wear and tear cannot be claimed against your bond** — this protection exists in WA just as in other states.
- ☐ [] **Understand hardship provisions exist.** Tenants experiencing hardship already have the right to apply to the Magistrates Court for additional time to secure alternative accommodation if facing termination — this existing safeguard applies regardless of how the broader no-grounds reform ultimately lands.

Quick Reference — Key WA Rental Application Facts (July 2026)

ITEM	DETAIL
Governing legislation	Residential Tenancies Act 1987 (WA)
No-grounds eviction ban	Proposed, not yet law as at July 2026 — check current status
Maximum pet bond	\$350 (recently increased)
Fair wear and tear	Cannot be claimed against bond
Hardship protection	Existing right to apply to Magistrates Court for extra time

© HouseHQ. General information only, current as at the date shown — not legal advice. Given active law reform in this area, confirm the current position with Consumer Protection WA before relying on any specific rule.